

7 Test run

Admittedly, test running a business won't be as much fun as test driving a car, but it's definitely essential to the health and well-being of your business in the long run. Test runs are used not just to check the functionality of your business, but to get a hang of the kind of customers and businesses that it best resonates with. This means that you may have to go through multiple test runs.



But as a potential business starter-upper, you must overcome hurdles like these. The good news is that investing your time in multiple test runs today, will help you decide on which types of customers and businesses to target, right from the get go. It also gives you the necessary insights to make the business model more suited for the customer group. Multiple test runs will help you avoid having to repurpose the business entirely at a later time – saving you both, time and resources. That also means that you may get rich faster.

8 Searching for future talent

Even though you are in the very early stages of developing your company, you should keep an eye out for talent. You may only have positions to fill in the future but it's always a good idea to have a talent pool to choose from. Most entrepreneurs – whether successful ones or those who have failed and moved on to founding successful startups after initial failures – will attest to how important it is to have the right kind of talent. Not only can a good team make or break a startup, it is the pillar upon which your startup will be able to scale eventually. It is therefore very important to pick the right kind of talent. A team that is cohesive is necessary but as they say conflict is important so gather people with differing backgrounds and thought processes. As long as they function productively under a good leader even weirdos are great.



9 Legal advice

Many things could go wrong while running a business. And while many take precautions and preventative measure, things can still go wrong despite everything. When this happens it's usually a storm of paperwork, and other insurance and legal issues. The biggest mistake entrepreneurs make is waiting for something to go wrong before they seek out legal advice.

From a mishap befalling one of your employees to a post falling on your office building, some things are just beyond your control. Now in these cases it's not unlikely for an employee to file a legal claim for injuries or damages they may have taken.



This would be the appropriate time for you seek legal advice from (preferably your own) a legal team.

Listening to all that legal advice and lawyer jargon might seem like an earful but this is all important stuff, so try to pay attention. All this information will be handy when you and your startup are actually in a pickle. And get yourself a legal team. Or at least a legal advisor.

10 Have plans for way beyond your launch date

No matter how good thinking on your feet is as a talent, most great leaders and entrepreneurs will vouch for the value of meticulous planning. Imagining all possible outcomes and scenarios isn't really practical or possible but contingencies and plans for likely outcomes should be made. If you have a playbook of sorts, no matter what the challenges might be, you have a bag of tricks to delve into when the going gets tough. The value of a Plan B can never be underestimated. Plan even for failure. The idea is to hope for the best but plan for the worst. Have a long term plan – a plan for the duration by which you are fairly confident that you can start raking in profits.

While planning, make sure that you have a contingency plan for the worst case scenario laid out. It's best to have a sales and marketing budget earmarked for at least the first two years of running the business.

